

memory by turning off the printer and check whether the printer cable is properly connected. If you still get the error, remove the printer drivers by going to Add/Remove Programs and reinstall them. If you still can't print, then check the parallel port settings by right-clicking My Computer and selecting Properties. Go to Device Manager, double-click 'Ports (COM and LPT)' and further double-click 'Printer Port (LPT1)'. Select the Resources tab and check the 'Conflicting device list' box for an IRQ (Interrupt Request line) or DMA (direct memory access, a fast link to your computer's RAM) conflict. If another device is using the printer port's IRQ, disable that device or assign it a new IRQ. To disable the device, locate it in Device Manager, open its Properties dialog box, select the General tab, and check 'Disable in this hardware profile'. To look for a DMA conflict, first check whether your printer port is configured as an ECP port (the latest parallel port technology designed to speed up printing by using a DMA; older settings are Standard, Bi-directional, and EPP). If yours does support ECP, assign the



Your printer refuses to print

parallel port to an unused DMA, usually done in the PC's CMOS setup program. If your printer doesn't support ECP, configure the parallel port to a slower, compatible setting. The next-best option is EPP. If your printer doesn't support that either, go with Standard—the slowest, yet the most compatible setting.

WINDOWS 9x

Fatal exception errors when restarting Windows 98

Q I have Windows 98 and I keep getting fatal exception errors while restarting. The error looks something like this: "Fatal Exception OE occurred at 015:BFF712B. The current application will be terminated. Press Ctrl + Alt + Del." My machine then automatically restarts in Safe mode and I can't do anything. Help me.

A It seems one of the critical files have been corrupted and this error message is a result of that, as well as the reason why your machine automatically boots

in safe mode. To solve this problem, simply reinstall Windows.

Incomplete defragmentation in Windows 98

Q I use Windows 98 but am unable to defragment my hard disk completely. As soon as it reaches 10 per cent, it begins restarting the program. What can I do?

A This is a common problem faced by most Windows 98 users and it usually occurs when some program is running in the background. In order to completely defragment your hard drive, boot in Safe mode and run the defragment program.

Windows protection error

Q Whenever I boot my PC I get an error saying, "Windows Protection Error while Initialising Device." Restarting or reinstalling does not help.

A You might have installed incorrect drivers for one of the devices of your system, or the drivers might have been corrupted. You can boot in Safe mode and remove the device. If you cannot boot in Safe mode, you will have to remove and reinstall Windows.

System hangs on shutdown

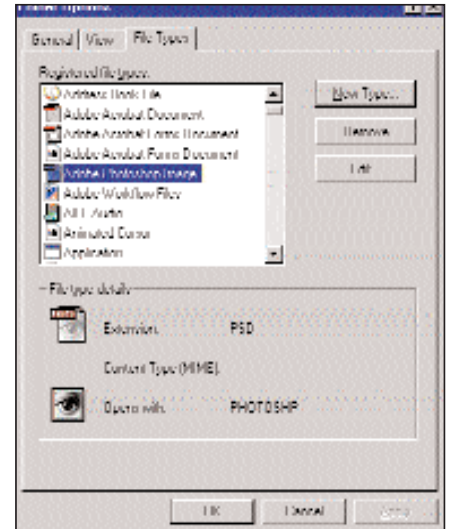
Q I use Windows 98. Often when I shut down the system, it hangs leaving me with a blank screen and a flashing cursor.

A This problem occurs because the 'Disable fast shutdown' option is unchecked. To enable this option, go to **Start > Run** and type **msconfig**; press [Enter]. Then select the Advanced button and check 'Disable Fast Shutdown'. This will solve your problem.

Associating applications with file type

Q How do I associate the original application with a given file type?

A To associate an original application with its file type you should go to Windows Explorer and choose **Tools > Folder Options > File Types** to display all the registered file types. To change an application launched with these file types, select the file type, say, GIF, HTML or JPEG, and choose Edit. In the Edit file type box, manually type in the name and the path of the application you wish to launch with the file type you have chosen. In this manner you



Associate the right file extension with the program

can change the file association with any application.

Backing up the registry

Q How do I backup my registry?

A It's quite easy to back up the Windows 95/98/Me registry. Open the Registry Editor by typing **Regedit** in the Run dialog box under the Start menu. Click on the Registry menu, and select Export Registry File. Verify the following items in the Export Registry File dialog box:

Save in: Desktop (for example)
File name: Registry Backup
Save as type: Registration Files
Export range: All

Click Save and Exit the Registry Editor. Check that an icon labelled 'Registry Backup.reg' is on the desktop.

Once you have made a backup of the registry, you can make whatever edits you had set out to do. It is always advisable to make one edit at a time since it is easier to rectify.

If the change you made works fine then delete the .reg file on the desktop. If the change you made is not desirable, then your backup will come handy. Double-click on the registry file backed up on the desktop—it will restore the registry to its previous state.

Windows 9x has a feature in which after each successful start, a backup of that registry is made and saved. Just in case something does go wrong, this backup can be used to restore the system to a previously known 'good' state.

To restore the registry, restart in